Diana Chirica

Full-Stack Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Full-stack engineer who ships backend systems end to end, from AWS serverless infrastructure and Terraform up to the APIs and data models on top. Over the past year built a real-time notification service on AWS, rebuilt slow core API endpoints, and worked across MySQL, PostgreSQL, and Elasticsearch on a live commercial platform. Strong in TypeScript and TDD.

SKILLS

Cloud & infrastructure: AWS (API Gateway, RDS, S3, Lambda), Terraform, serverless architecture, Node.js

Backend: PHP, Laravel, Ruby on Rails, REST & WebSocket APIs, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, database migrations, automated testing

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, PHP, Ruby, SQL, HTML5, CSS3

Frontend: React, Next.js, Redux, Tailwind CSS, jQuery, Axios

Tools & other: Git, Stripe, Bugsnag, YouTube Data API, RSpec, TDD

EXPERIENCE

Lickd, Software Engineer — Jun 2025 - Jun 2026

Music-licensing platform · PHP, Laravel, AWS, Terraform, Elasticsearch

- Built a serverless real-time WebSocket notification service end to end, owning it from scoping to production: provisioned AWS infrastructure with Terraform (API Gateway, RDS, S3), added JWT authentication on connect with read and clear routes, and integrated it across the Laravel backend and React frontend.
- Diagnosed and rebuilt the slow dashboard-content endpoint and led platform-wide N+1 query elimination, restoring consistent response times on user-facing pages.
- Traced and fixed subscription and discount billing bugs sourced from Stripe data, adding logging to track discount end dates through the payment flow.
- Built third-party integrations including YouTube Data API video retrieval and automated SFTP/S3 royalty delivery for major-label reporting with correct currency and territory handling.
- Refactored the track-validation system across a multi-ticket migration, extracting shared trait-based validators and adding enums for invalidation reasons to improve testability, and upgraded Node.js Lambda functions used in claims processing.
- Strengthened reliability and observability with Bugsnag, Slack alerting, and threshold-based error alerts, and worked in an AI-first workflow around Claude Code, shifting from writing code to reviewing, testing, and hardening AI-generated pull requests against detailed specs.

KDFG, Frontend Engineer — Mar 2024 - 2025

Next.js, React, JavaScript, Tailwind CSS

- Built a React authentication system with secure session handling and protected client access.
- Improved performance on large datasets by adding pagination and filtering in React, reducing load times and smoothing the user experience.

Amwins, MTA Fleet Technician · **Acorn Financial Services**, MTA Fleet Assistant — 2018 - 2022

- Reduced transaction errors by streamlining policy workflows and optimising systems; maintained full client retention through a managerial transition (pre-engineering roles, London).

PROJECTS

Faebook, full-stack social network

Ruby on Rails, React, Redux, PostgreSQL, TypeScript · Live GitHub

- Built a RESTful single-page social platform with TDD (90%+ coverage), real-time chat over WebSockets, and AWS S3 media storage.

Chess, two-player console game

Ruby, React, Redux, PostgreSQL · GitHub

- Developed a fully functional terminal chess game applying OOP principles and multi-level inheritance.

EDUCATION

App Academy, 1000+ hour full-stack immersive (<2% acceptance). TDD, OOP, REST, algorithms & data structures. 2022

Interests: Rock climbing, powerlifting, reading, creative writing.